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California Regional Water Quality Control Board Central Valley Region

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FILE



Arnold
Schwarzenegger
Governor

23 January 2009

Ed A. Wristen, Tulare Unit Chief
California Department of Forestry and Fire Protection
1968 S. Lovers Lane
Visalia, CA 93292

NOTICE OF APPLICABILITY

WATER QUALITY ORDER NO. 97-10-DWQ-R5017, GENERAL WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS FOR DISCHARGES TO LAND BY SMALL DOMESTIC WASTEWATER TREATMENT SYSTEMS, CALIFORNIA DEPARTMENT OF FORESTRY AND FIRE PROTECTION, MOUNTAIN HOME CONSERVATION CAMP, TULARE COUNTY

The California Department of Forestry and Fire Protection (Cal-Fire) submitted a Report of Waste Discharge (RWD), dated 17 September 2008, for discharges of treated domestic wastewater from the Mountain Home Conservation Camp (Camp) Wastewater Treatment Facility (WWTF). The RWD proposes elimination of permitted discharges to surface water from the WWTF. Cal-Fire submitted an addendum to the RWD, dated 16 December 2008, requesting coverage under Water Quality Order No. 97-10-DWQ, *General Waste Discharge Requirements for Discharges to Land by Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems* (hereafter General Order). Cal-Fire leases the Camp property and operates the WWTF.

Based on the information provided in the RWD, we have determined that discharges from the WWTF meet the conditions for enrollment under the General Order. Cal-Fire shall comply with the General Order Prohibitions; Requirements applicable to "All Small Domestic Systems", "Activated Sludge Systems," and "Surface Disposal Systems"; Ground Water and Surface Water Limitations; Provisions applicable to "All Small Domestic Systems", "Activated Sludge Systems," and "Surface Disposal Systems"; and Facility Specific Requirements included in this Notice of Applicability (NOA). Cal-Fire is hereby assigned General Order **No. 97-10-DWQ-R5017** for the discharge.

PROJECT LOCATION

Cal-Fire operates the Camp, which is about 7.5 miles northeast of Springville at an elevation of 4,500 feet, as shown in NOA Attachment 1, on U.S. Forest Service land that is under long-term lease to Cal-Fire. The area is typical Sierra foothill oak and conifer woodland, and primary land uses are limited agriculture, cattle grazing, and native wildlife habitat.



Supervising Engineer

Surface water drainage is to Bear Creek, a tributary of the North Fork of the Tule River and a water of the United States. The Tule River is in the Tulare Lake basin. The *Water Quality Control Plan for the Tulare Lake Basin, Second Edition, Revised January 2004* (Basin Plan)

designates beneficial uses, establishes water quality objectives, and contains implementation programs and policies to achieve water quality objectives for all waters of the Basin.

PROJECT DESCRIPTION

The Camp houses on average about 108 inmates, but can accommodate up to 112. The Camp has kitchen and laundry facilities. Grease from kitchen waste is removed through a grease trap. The monthly average daily wastewater flow from the Camp is about 0.010 mgd.

The WWTF consists of a 10,000 gallon septic tank that discharges to a sequential batch reactor/activated sludge treatment system. Effluent from the reactors passes through a tertiary filter and is then chlorinated. Sludge is pumped to an aerated digester and periodically hauled off site along with septic tank waste to a county approved septage site. The WWTF has the capacity to treat 0.016 mgd of wastewater. Tertiary treated effluent is disposed of in five unlined evaporation/percolation ponds that have a total of two million gallons of storage capacity. During dry weather conditions, effluent is discharged to a spray field. A process flow diagram is included as NOA Attachment 2.

The RWD describes Cal-Fire's intent to construct a containment berm and concrete sump with two pumps to capture effluent runoff from the sprayfield and to disconnect the piped outfall to Bear Creek, thus eliminating the possibility for discharge of pollutants to surface water.

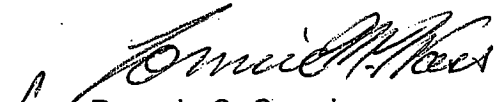
The RWD also indicates that to prevent applied effluent from commingling with storm water runoff from the spray field during precipitation events, Cal-Fire will collect all spray field runoff from effluent application and all runoff from the sprayfield for 24 hours following cessation of effluent application and return it to the ponds. Additionally, Cal-Fire will not use the spray field during precipitation events, when the sprayfield is covered with snow, or when saturated soil conditions exist.

FACILITY-SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS

1. The WWTF shall be operated in accordance with Cal-Fire's RWD and amendments and addendums, thereto, and the requirements contained in the General Order.
2. As a means for determining compliance with General Order Requirement No. B.1.c, discharge flow shall not exceed 0.016 mgd.
3. Discharge to the spray field is prohibited until Cal-Fire submits a properly signed and stamped technical report from a California registered civil engineer that certifies the containment berm and concrete sump were constructed as designed and are fully operational, and that the piped outfall to Bear Creek is permanently disconnected.

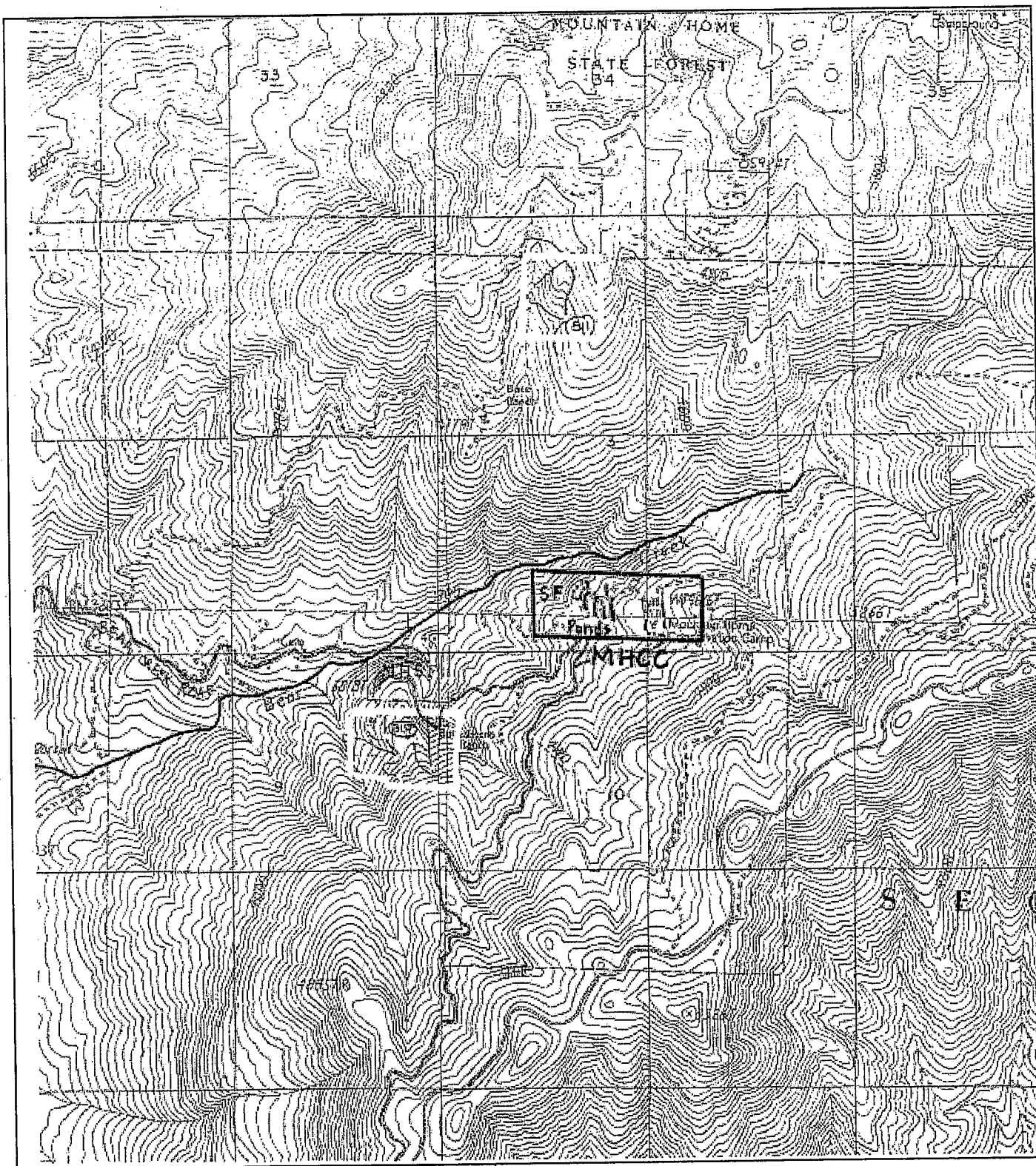
4. As a means of ensuring compliance with General Order Limitation No. C.2., any runoff from the spray field that occurs while the spray field is in operation, or that occurs during a period of not less than 24-hours following cessation of spray field operation, shall be collected in the sump and returned to the ponds.
5. Discharge to the spray field is prohibited during precipitation events, when snow is present, or when saturated soil conditions exist.
6. Sludge removal and septage hauling records shall be kept and reported in each annual report (**due 1 February**).
7. Discharge of wastewater at a location or in a manner different from that described in the Project Description is prohibited.
8. This NOA is not transferable. Prior to transfer of WWTF ownership from Cal-Fire, or prior to authorization of a new site operator, the new owner or operator shall submit a Report of Waste Discharge requesting coverage under the General Order.
9. Pursuant to California Water Code Section 13267, Cal-Fire shall comply with the reporting requirements of this letter and monitoring described in *Monitoring and Reporting Program No. R5-2009-0808* (NOA Attachment 3) in lieu of State Water Resources Control Board Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 97-10-DWQ (General Order Attachment A).
10. All technical reports required herein that involve evaluation, or other work requiring interpretation and proper application of engineering or geologic sciences, shall be prepared by or under the direction of persons registered to practice in California pursuant to California Business and Professions Code, sections 6735, 7835, and 7835.1. To demonstrate compliance with Title 16, California Code of Regulations, sections 415 and 3065, all technical reports must contain a statement of the qualifications of the responsible registered professional(s). As required by these laws, completed technical reports must bear the signature(s) and seal(s) of the registered professional(s) in a manner such that all work can be clearly attributed to the professional responsible for the work.
11. Cal-Fire shall submit the required annual fee (as specified in the annual billing issued by the State Water Resources Control Board) until the NOA is terminated.
12. Failure to abide by the conditions of the General Order and this NOA, including *Monitoring and Reporting Program No. R5-2009-0808* could result in enforcement actions as authorized by provisions of the California Water Code.

This NOA has been entered into the California Integrated Water Quality System as Regulatory Measure 358730. If you have any questions regarding this NOA, please contact Debra Bates by email at dbates@waterboards.ca.gov , or by phone at (559) 445-6281.


Pamela C. Creedon
Executive Officer

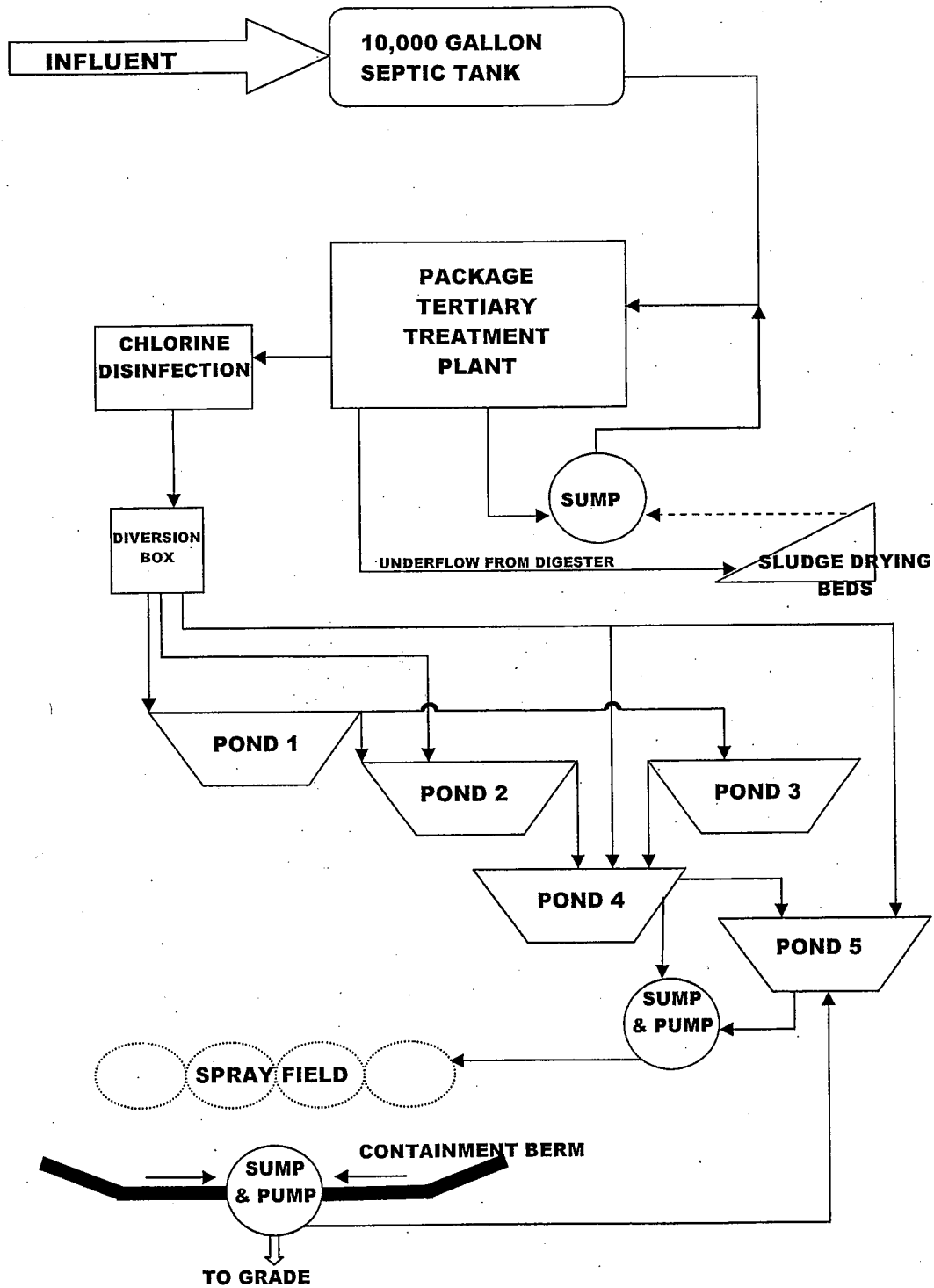
Enclosures: NOA Attachment 1: Location Map
NOA Attachment 2: Process Flow Diagram
NOA Attachment 3: Monitoring and Reporting Program No. R5-2009-0808
General Order:
Attachment A: Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 97-10-DWQ
Attachment B: Standard Provisions and Reporting Requirements for
Waste Discharge Requirements

cc: Doug Eberhardt, (WTR-5), U.S. Environmental Protection Agency, San Francisco
Priscilla Summers, District Supervisor, Western Divide Ranger District, U.S. Forest
Service, Springville
Phil Isorena, State Water Resources Control Board, DWQ, Sacramento (via email)
Doug Taylor, Associate Civil Engineer, Cal-Fire, Fresno
David McCarty, Chief Plant Operator, Mountain Home Conservation Camp
Dean Marston, Environmental Program Manager, Department of Fish and Game,
Fresno
Tulare County, Department of Health, Environmental Health System, Visalia
Tulare County, Department of Public Works and Planning, Visalia



NOA ATTACHMENT 1
VICINITY MAP
CAL-FIRE
MOUNTAIN HOME CONSERVATION CAMP
SECTION 3 & 10, T20S, R30E, MDB&M

NOA ATTACHMENT 2
SEWAGE PROCESS FLOW DIAGRAM
CAL-FIRE
MOUNTAIN HOME CONSERVATION CAMP



CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION

MONITORING AND REPORTING
PROGRAM NO. R5-2009-0808
FOR
CALIFORNIA DEPARTMENT OF FORESTRY AND FIRE PROTECTION
MOUNTAIN HOME CONSERVATION CAMP
TULARE COUNTY

This Monitoring and Reporting Program (MRP) is issued pursuant to California Water Code section 13267. The California Department of Forestry and Fire Protection (Cal-Fire) shall not implement any changes to this MRP unless and until the Executive Officer issues a revised MRP. Sample locations are described below. Changes to sample location(s) shall be established with concurrence of Regional Water Board staff.

All analyses shall be performed in accordance with the latest edition of *Guidelines Establishing Test Procedures for Analysis of Pollutants*, promulgated by USEPA (40 CFR 136), or other procedures approved by the Regional Water Board staff. In reporting data, the Cal-Fire shall indicate whether any analysis was performed using a method not in conformance with USEPA's Guidelines.

TERTIARY TREATMENT SYSTEM MONITORING

INFLUENT MONITORING

Samples shall be collected at approximately the same time as effluent samples and should be representative of the influent. Samples shall be taken at the sequential batch reactor headworks prior to entering the treatment system. Influent monitoring shall include at least the following:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
BOD ₅ ¹	mg/L	Grab	Monthly
Total Suspended Solids	mg/L	Grab	Monthly

¹ 5-day, 20 °C biochemical oxygen demand.

EFFLUENT MONITORING

Effluent samples shall be collected just after discharge from the WWTF and prior to discharge to the evaporation/percolation ponds. Effluent samples shall be representative of the volume and quality of the discharge. Time of collection of grab samples shall be recorded. Effluent monitoring shall include at least the following:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
Flow	gpd	Metered	Continuous
Total Chlorine Residual	mg/L, g/day	Metered	Continuous
BOD ₅ ¹	mg/L, g/day	24-hr composite ²	Weekly
Total Suspended Solids	mg/L, g/day	24-hr composite ²	Weekly

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
EC	umhos/cm	24-hr composite ²	Weekly
Settleable Solids	mL/L	24-hr composite ²	Weekly
pH	pH units	Grab	Weekly
Total Coliform Organisms	MPN/100 mL	Grab	Weekly

¹ 5-day, biochemical oxygen demand.

² The BOD and TSS samples shall be flow proportional composite samples.

SPRAY FIELD MONITORING

The Discharger shall inspect the spray field at least once per week during the period that it is in use. In conducting the inspection, a log shall be kept of the spray field conditions. The log shall include notes on broken pipes, clogged or plugged sprinkler heads. Attention shall be given to the presence or absence of the following:

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------|
| a. Breaches of berms | b. Erosion |
| c. Overspray off of the disposal site | d. Standing Water |
| e. Runoff | |

Notes on the spray field shall be summarized in the monthly monitoring report, including a record of the days the sprayfield was in use. Where the operation and maintenance manual indicates remedial action is necessary, the Discharger shall briefly explain in the transmittal what action has been taken or is scheduled to be taken.

POND MONITORING

Pond water samples shall be collected at a depth of one foot from each pond, opposite the inlet. Ponds shall be monitored during periods when water is present in the ponds. Pond water monitoring shall include the following:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
Dissolved Oxygen ¹	mg/L	Grab	Weekly
Freeboard ²	feet	Observation	Monthly

¹ Samples shall be collected between 0800 and 0900 hours.

² Freeboard shall be measured for all ponds to the nearest tenth of a foot.

Permanent markers shall be placed in the ponds with calibration marks indicating the water level at design capacity and available operational freeboard.

WATER SUPPLY MONITORING

The on-site domestic well(s) shall be monitored annually for EC.

SLUDGE AND SEPTAGE MONITORING

To ensure that discharges to the WWTF are not degrading sludge quality, Cal-Fire shall collect a composite sample of sludge at least annually in accordance with EPA's *POTW Sludge Sampling and Analysis Guidance Document, August 1989*, and test for metals:

Arsenic	Copper	Nickel
Cadmium	Lead	Selenium
Molybdenum	Mercury	Zinc

Sampling records shall be retained for a minimum of five years. A log shall be kept of sludge quantities generated from the tertiary treatment plant, as well as quantities of sludge pumped from the septic tank, and of handling, application and disposal activities. The frequency of entries is discretionary; however, the log should be complete enough to serve as a basis for part of the annual report. Prior to any disposal or land application of sewage sludge, or removal of sewage sludge from the WWTF, the monitoring and record keeping requirements of 40 CFR 503 shall be met.

REPORTING

Cal-Fire shall report monitoring data and information as required in this MRP. Monitoring reports shall be submitted to the Regional Board by the **1st day of second month following sampling**. All monitoring reports shall comply with the signatory requirements in Standard Provisions, Monitoring and Reporting Requirement B.2. Annual monitoring results shall be submitted by **1 February** of each year.

In reporting the monitoring data, Cal-Fire shall arrange the data in tabular form so that the date, the constituents, and the concentrations are readily discernible. The data shall be summarized in such a manner as to clearly illustrate whether the discharge complies with waste discharge requirements. The highest daily maximum for the month, monthly averages, medians, and removal efficiencies (%) for BOD and Total Suspended Solids, should be determined and recorded.

If Cal-Fire monitors any pollutant at the locations designated herein more frequently than is required by this Order, the results of such monitoring shall be included in the calculation and reporting of the values required in the discharge monitoring report form. Such increased frequency shall be indicated on the discharge monitoring form.

By **1 February** of each year, Cal-Fire shall submit a written report to the Executive Officer containing the following:

- The names, certificate grades, and general responsibilities of all persons in charge of wastewater treatment and disposal (Standard Provision A.5).
- The names and telephone numbers of persons to contact regarding the WWTF for emergency and routine situations.

- c. A statement certifying when monitoring instruments and devices were last calibrated (for purposes of assuring compliance with this Order), including identification of who performed the calibration (Standard Provision C.6).
- d. A statement certifying whether the current operation and maintenance manual, and contingency plan, reflect the wastewater treatment plant as currently constructed and operated, and the dates when these documents were last revised and last reviewed for adequacy.

Cal-Fire shall also submit an annual report to the Regional Water Board with both tabular and graphical summaries of the monitoring data obtained during the previous year. The annual report shall be submitted hardcopy and in an electronic format (e.g. Microsoft Excel) subject to the approval of the Executive Officer. The report shall discuss the compliance record. If violations have occurred, the report shall also discuss the corrective actions taken and planned to bring the discharge into full compliance with the waste discharge requirements.

Cal-Fire shall submit monitoring reports to:

California Regional Water Quality Control Board
Central Valley Region
1685 E Street
Fresno, CA 93706

The following information is to be included on all monitoring and annual reports, as well as any report transmittal letters, submitted to the Regional Water Board:

The agency name, facility name, WDRs Order number, WDID number, and contact information (telephone number and email address, if available).

Cal-Fire shall implement the above MRP on the first day of the month following the issuance of the Notice of Applicability.

Ordered by:

Pamela C. Creedon
for PAMELA C. CREEDON, Executive Officer

1/23/2009
(Date)